which any Indian who had practical banking experience in London was eligible for entry.

Shroff took the advice and joined the London School of Economics to do a BSc (Banking and Finance). But Shroff ran into a major roadblock when he tried to secure an apprenticeship at a London bank. There was no precedent of accepting an Indian apprentice. Fortunately for Shroff, Ratanji Dadabhoy Tata was also in London at the time. He took him to a small American bank, the Equitable Trust Company of New York (which was subsequently merged with Chase Bank) and introduced him to the manager. Shroff was taken on as an apprentice and he worked here for the next three-and-a-quarter years simultaneously completing his degree by attending evening classes.

Ratanji offered him a job in the Tata Industrial Bank (TIB) but this came to nothing because soon after it was absorbed by the Central Bank of India. Shroff also tried his luck with the Imperial Bank only to be told that he was not eligible because he had worked at an American bank. He never forgot the slight nor forgave the Imperial Bank. He needled them at every annual general meeting and many years later, when he was invited to join the Board of the bank, it must have given him great pleasure to turn them down. Shroff also met Sir Phiroze Sethna, Chairman of the Central Bank of India, who promised him a suitable job when he returned to Bombay. His letter of introduction to Sorabji Pochkhanawala proved futile because Sorabji offered him a job which he did not consider worthwhile.

A desperate Shroff sought help from Ratanji who sent him to Batlivala & Karani then among the biggest broking firms in Bombay and a virtual house broker for the Tatas. Shroff worked with them till he joined Tatas in 1940. Shroff proved beyond doubt that his *metier* was the stock market. His ability to read balance sheets coupled with his grounding in economics gave him the reputation of being a financial wizard. His stockbroking experience also helped him develop a unique ability to network and raise finances quickly when the need arose. He made visits to factories and did detailed research before making investment decisions. His advice: see the man behind the project and not just the project.

Shroff was also closely associated with the Bombay Shareholders' Association and was an active member of the IMC becoming its Vice President in 1936. He was also actively associated with FICCI and provided